

excites you and makes you want to do *more and more and more and better and better and better*, that's what you need to move toward at all times.

Don't burn bridges

You never know when a relationship you've forged in your past might come in handy later on, even the ones you completely don't expect. Thus, even if you feel wronged in a situation or want "revenge" on some people—or even if you just feel an urge to spread negative gossip—resist it. As you get older, you'll find yourself time and time again bumping into people that you forged relationships with earlier on; if you burned those bridges, you'll find that eventually you'll have burnt the very bridge that you need to cross to get ahead. My advice? Never spread a negative word about anyone, because it never helps.

Keep in touch!

When you do build a bridge with someone, don't let it get old and worn-out; spend the time to keep in touch with that person. Shoot them an email or a phone call every once in a while just to see what they're up to. When it's clear they need help and you can easily provide it, *always* provide it. I found the book *Never Eat Alone* by Keith Ferrazzi to be particularly powerful in this regard.

I'm rather introverted, and it's often a challenge for me to initiate and then keep communication going with someone, and this book provided tons of tips on how (and why) to keep in contact with people.

3. Live frugal!

For a lot of people, frugality is a nine-letter word for cheap. They think of people doing stuff like buying cartloads of generic products, using 40 coupons in the checkout aisle, wearing patched clothing, driving a rusted-out old vehicle, and other such things that it's easy to look down your nose at.

Here's a secret, something that I've witnessed several times in my own life and read about many more: Those frugal people that you look down your nose at often have a mountain of cash in the bank (not always, of course, but more often than you think). They're not drowning in a mortgage, they're not making payments on a five-figure credit card debt. They're not working to death on the weekends or drowning an ulcer in Pepto-Bismol. They're living their life according to their own rules.

The best part is that we can all apply some of those same rules in our own life. Here's what you can do to start reducing that spending.